

- c) loved school and classes and joined every extracurricular activity, knowing it would benefit you in the future.
- d) made the honor roll without fail, and put your grades before anything else, including any fun.

If you answered D, you're probably well suited for college; high school was just a temporary stop on your way to higher education. Choose the school and your course load wisely, and remember: The fact that you were a superstar in high school doesn't mean you'll shine in college. Be competitive and don't lose that edge. Choose your major with care, because dropping classes and changing course loads adds up.

If you answered C, you certainly have the discipline for college, but if your dream job doesn't require a postsecondary degree, then consider skipping it in favor of a trade or opening a business. You like to work and you have a social streak. You already know you're good at talking to people and probably good at team-building, too. The ranks of successful entrepreneurs who never went to postsecondary school are legion. Think clearly about the postsecondary decision before you take on massive debt.

If you answered A or B, then I must say, I was just like you. Still, I went to college. It was the right choice in the end for me, but it might not be for you. Discipline can be learned, and you'll need it if you want to get the best bang for your tuition buck. But if you've taken my advice to heart, I hope you'll see that not choosing to pursue a college degree isn't in any way a failure. Your path to financial well-being is as golden as any undergrad's, maybe even more so, provided you develop your own skills in a suitable direction. Again, I ask you, have you considered the trades?

2. You chose your college or university based on:

- a) the awards, scholarships, and financial aid package they offered you.
- b) proximity. It was the closest one to home and you aren't going to be living on campus.